

BREATHING AND VOCALIZATION

THE MOVEMENTS OF BREATHING, ALSO KNOWN AS BODILY RESPIRATION, BRING FRESH AIR CONTAINING OXYGEN DEEP INTO THE LUNGS AND THEN REMOVE STALE AIR CONTAINING THE WASTE PRODUCT CARBON DIOXIDE.

BREATHING

The movement of air into and out of the lungs is generated by differences in pressure within the lungs compared to the surrounding atmospheric pressure. These differences are produced by forcefully expanding the lungs by muscular action, and then passively allowing them to return to their former size. The rate and depth of breathing can be consciously modified. However, the underlying need to breathe is controlled by an area of the brain where responses to regulate the breathing muscles occur according to the levels of carbon dioxide and oxygen in the blood.

INHALATION

The chief muscles used in respiration at rest are the diaphragm at the base of the chest and the external intercostals between the ribs. For forceful inhalation, additional muscles assist in moving the ribs and sternum to expand the chest further and stretch the lungs even more.

